Sustainability Report 2024

PwC Slovakia

December 2025

www.pwc.com/sk/en

Contents

Foreword

Martin Gallovič
Country Managing Partner

Dear Readers,

Welcome to our first separate sustainability report created in accordance with EFRAG Voluntary Sustainability reporting Standard for non-listed SMEs (VSME).

In this report, we provide an overview of our ESG (Environmental, Social and Governance) performance and approaches for the calendar year 2024.

In 2024, AI was a key topic. PwC supports clients in using AI effectively for transforming and streamlining processes and achieving strategic growth. We faced a number of challenges due to the rapid development of AI, cybersecurity, and automation, which affected our company in different areas. Our main goal is to ensure that technology supports the needs of people and our clients, while contributing to sustainable development.

The growing importance of climate change is an undeniable reality and a focus of attention for PwC Slovakia. We are intensively striving to raise awareness of this important issue using all available means. We offer a diverse range of ESG-related services focusing on sustainable development advice, carbon footprint calculation, and reporting non-financial, sustainability-related information. We support and assist our clients with defining and implementing ESG strategies across all three pillars – environmental, social, and governance.

We are the largest consulting company in Slovakia and place great emphasis on the continuous education of our staff and support for community activities. Our employees are given time to work for diverse communities, which contributes to the improvement of the public sphere.

This report is an important step towards greater transparency and responsibility to our stakeholders. We want to give you a better understanding of our responsibilities and measures as regards sustainability. We hope you will enjoy reading our sustainability report for 2024 and will gain a more complete picture of our company. I believe that together we can make a change and contribute to a better and more sustainable future.

General information

1.1 Basis for preparation

This is PwC Slovakia's first sustainability report compiled in accordance with the VSME standard. The report uses the basic and comprehensive module of the VSME standard. The VSME Index, which you can find at the end of this report, lists all material topics and indicators, with links to the pages where this information is disclosed. No disclosure has been omitted due it containing confidential or sensitive information.

All published information relates to PwC Slovakia, which includes the legal entities listed below in the table - List of companies included in the report.

All qualitative and quantitative data in this report applies to the calendar year 2024 (1 January 2024 to 31 December 2024), unless stated otherwise. The reporting period is consistent with the reporting period for which the financial statements and the annual report were prepared, except for PricewaterhouseCoopers CEE Firm Services s.r.o., for which the sustainability reporting period is identical with that of other Slovak PwC entities (1 January 2024 to 31 December 2024). The financial reporting period is from 1 July 2023 to 30 June 2024.

List of companies included in the report		NACE code
Legal form	PricewaterhouseCoopers Slovensko, s. r. o.	N.69.20
	PricewaterhouseCoopers Tax, k. s.	N.69.20
	PricewaterhouseCoopers Advisory s. r. o.	N.70.20
	PricewaterhouseCoopers CEE Firm Services s. r. o.	N.70.20
	PricewaterhouseCoopers Legal, s. r. o.	N.69.10
Address of all entities	Karadžičova 2, 815 32 Bratislava, Slovak Republic	

Branches and location of significant assets

Sites	Address	Postal code	City	Country	Coordinates (geolocation)
Registered Branch	Karadžičova 2	815 32	Bratislava	Slovak Republic	48.14536329707655 17.1243354589881
Registered Branch	Protifašistických bojovníkov 11	040 01	Košice	Slovenská republika	48.718259494191294 21.265017528112026

Basic Company Information	
Net assets	€80,016 thousand
Net turnover	€90,728 thousand
Number of employees (total number as at 31 December 2024)	950

Three of our companies, PricewaterhouseCoopers Slovensko, s.r.o., PricewaterhouseCoopers Advisory s.r.o. and PricewaterhouseCoopers Tax, k.s., are ISO 14 001 environmental management certified.

[B1]

1.2 Strategy: Business Model and Sustainability

1.2.1 Value creation model

Our mission is to build trust in society and solve important problems. Our strategy is focused on helping clients build trust with their partners and achieve sustainable results. We achieve this by bringing together diverse people, skills, experiences and technology.

Everything we do is focused on creating value for clients, their partners, society, colleagues and the Company. Transparency and credibility are of vital importance. We strive to generate long-term value throughout the value chain – for example, via supplier contracts with a positive impact on people and the environment.

370,393

Global total of PwC staff in FY24

86%

Our client portfolio includes 86% of Fortune Global 500 companies

4.3%

In FY24, revenues in the PwC CEE region increased by 4.3%

$55.4 billion

In FY24, global PwC revenues were $55.4 billion

[GRI 201-1]

* Data referring to PwC globally was prepared at 30 June 2024 (end of FY24).

PwC Global

PwC is a global* company with offices in 149 countries and more than 370,000 employees and partners. The company is a global leader in audit, tax and advisory services for clients from various industries.

Globally, PwC serves more than 170,000 clients at 656 offices. 86% of Fortune Global 500 companies are part of PwC's client portfolio.

1.2.3 PwC Slovakia

PwC Slovakia is a member of the international PwC network. In 2024, the company was managed by 19 partners. The companies that comprise PwC Slovakia have been operating on the Slovak market since 1991 and provide audit, tax, legal, advisory, consulting and educational services.

In addition to local companies, our clients are also international companies from various sectors, non-profit organizations, government institutions and individuals.

Sectors and markets for which we provide services

- Automotive
- Banking and Finance
- Energy
- Retail
- Real Estate
- Insurance
- Telecommunications
- Public Sector
- Media
- Pharma and Healthcare
- Industrial Production

One of our strategic goals is to help clients transform their business towards sustainability so the proposed solutions add value to the company. Due to our significant impact on society, we are actively engaged in responsible business to create better conditions for a sustainable future. Although we are a non-manufacturing company, we are aware that our activities have an impact on the environment. We assess and monitor our impact on material consumption, energy, emissions and waste. We have adopted a concrete strategy and are engaged in global initiatives in individual areas to achieve our goals.

Our global strategy **The New Equation** commits us to transforming our business model, decarbonising our value chain, increasing transparency, and supporting the development of sustainability reporting methods.

1.2.4 Sustainable supply chain

As a key market leader, we are fully aware of our responsibility to create a supply chain based on ethical standards and sustainability principles. In 2024, approximately 500 suppliers from various sectors provided us with their services, including legal and notary services, professional advice on information technology, photographic and marketing, waste collection and disposal services, and services related to the provision of training for employees.

PwC's suppliers are required to comply with our Global Third-Party Code of Conduct and have processes in place to combat money laundering, conflicts of interest, corruption and fraud and adopt the same standards of conduct for their employees and associates.

Discrimination against their employees or during the recruitment process by third parties is unacceptable. Employers must guarantee at least the current minimum wage and fair evaluation of employees in accordance with the relevant laws and regulations in the countries where they operate. We demand zero tolerance for inappropriate behaviour, including sexual harassment and bullying, to ensure a healthy and safe work environment in accordance with globally recognized human rights and freedom of association of employees

Third parties may report violations of ethical and professional standards, anonymously via PwC's Global Ethics and Compliance helpline or by contacting our company representatives, without risk of retaliatory measures.

Environmental assessment of suppliers

Based on the above Global Third-Party Code of Conduct, we expect our suppliers to identify and manage their environmental impacts. It is important to us that our suppliers minimize their GHG emissions and actively participate in initiatives to promote environmental sustainability.

1.2.5 Client relations

As a global audit, accounting, and consulting firm, we have extensive internal processes in place for approving assignments to ensure we are independent of all our clients, and comply with the Act on Protection against the Legalization of Proceeds of Crime and Protection against Financing Terrorism (Anti-Money Laundering Act or AML Act). Prior to concluding business contracts with third parties, we thoroughly check their business behaviour and ethical values, to avoid possible adverse impacts of future cooperation. We are obliged to carry out these procedures before starting our work and during our cooperation. We reassess our clients once a year and, based on these assessments, decide on possibilities for future cooperation. If unacceptable facts are discovered, we decline cooperation or withdraw from the contract.

[C1]

1.3 Practices, policies and future initiatives for transitioning towards a more sustainable economy

PwC has been integrating sustainability principles into its strategy and practice. We have also led by example by publishing our fourth sustainability report in 2024 in accordance with the standards of the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI).

In addition, we have prepared our sustainability report in accordance with the VSME standard on a voluntary basis for the first time. In 2026, our firm on CEE region level plans to publish a consolidated sustainability report for the financial year 2025 in accordance with European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRS).

As part of our sustainability vision, we have adopted policies and set targets in areas that are important to us and are working to meet them.

1.3.1. Sustainability practices

Environment and climate protection

We act so as to eliminate our negative environmental impacts. Individual companies within PwC Slovakia meet and comply with all statutory conditions relating to environmental protection. We apply a comprehensive approach to environmental protection in accordance with the concept of sustainable development supported by the ISO 14 001 Environmental Management System. We apply measures in our operations to reduce energy and paper consumption, the production of plastic waste and the promotion of sorting, and the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions and increase the awareness of employees regarding environmental topics and reducing the impact of business and individual activities on the environment. As regards reducing climate change and greenhouse gas emissions, we proceed in accordance with PwC's global SBTi targets and commitment to achieving net zero. Similarly, we motivate our suppliers to set climate targets. As part of our purchases, we take into account the lifespan and usability of products compared to competing products, their recyclability, energy efficiency and service or repair options.

Social area

We focus on creating high quality working conditions and adhering to the principle of equal treatment in our workplace. We place emphasis on fairness, diversity, inclusion, work-life balance and employee health and safety. All employees must comply with our global PwC Code of Conduct. The Global PwC Third-Party Code of Conduct governs relations with suppliers and business partners (see Chapter 1.2.4 Sustainable Supply Chain). Breaches of ethical conduct and human rights can be reported on our Ethics Helpline. To ensure a healthy working environment conducive to cooperation, we apply the People Value Proposition Framework to employees. This includes principles such as innovative work driven by purpose, mutual care, diversity, equality and inclusion, growth and development. It provides development programs, training, and well-being activities, we support a hybrid work model and work-life balance. Employees can participate in volunteer activities and benefits. We mitigate the risk of burnout via initiatives such as Be Well, Work Well and Activate Yourself, which support physical, mental, emotional and spiritual well-being.

Governance

Measures are taken to minimize risks arising from violations of the independence principle, conflict of interest, data protection, corruption and bribery, and other areas. PwC Slovakia is fully engaged in preventing corruption and encourages its employees to report breaches immediately in accordance with our internal rules and applicable legislation. We have zero tolerance for corruption and reprisals against those who report corruption. Newly-hired employees are required to familiarise themselves with these rules and declare on a regular basis that they will comply with them.

Our employees are informed about the above aspects of sustainability in regular newsletters, awareness campaigns and training sessions.

1.3.2 Sustainability policies

Environment and climate protection

Measures related to climate change and environmental protection are covered in the environmental policy, travel policy, internal directive on waste reduction and separation and other policies. Our environmental policy includes a Net Zero climate commitment. The policy covers monitoring paper consumption, using recycled paper, separating waste and reducing waste production, reducing emissions from business trips, the use of renewable energies and the organization of internal environmental campaigns.

Social area

We apply our We Care policy. The generally applicable rules of conduct are defined in the Code of Conduct, which is binding for employees, suppliers and business partners. The provisions of the PwC Global Data Protection Policy and the CEE Secure Workplace Policy are also applied.

Governance

The PwC network has standards in place covering prevention of money laundering, ensuring fair competition and fighting corruption. Zero tolerance refers to violations of rules set at the global and local level for individual entities. The Code of Conduct is a central policy binding for all PwC employees globally. In addition, policies for specific areas have been adopted, such as the Global Independence Policy, which regulates potential conflicts of interest, the Anti-Corruption Directive and the Global Data Protection Policy. Reporting violations of ethical conduct is subject to the CEE Complaints and Allegations Policy.

1.3.3 Sustainability targets

Environment and climate protection

In 2021, PwC made a global Net Zero commitment to achieve net zero greenhouse gas emissions (Net Zero) with short-term targets for 2030. These targets were endorsed in 2021 by the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) as science-based targets (see Chapter 2.1.2. Greenhouse gas emission reduction targets and climate transition). Other goals include continuously reducing the consumption of office paper and limiting the production of unseparated waste.

Social area

The company has set qualitative targets for the social area (see table Description of practices, policies and future initiatives for transitioning to a more sustainable economy, below). We seek to increase employee satisfaction, promote diversity and inclusion, reduce turnover, ensure zero occupational injuries, develop employee talents and skills. Short-term targets have been adopted for the total number of training hours, total number of employees, number of new employees and the employee satisfaction rate (PEI index).

We seek to increase the quality of services, protect data and build trust with our consumers and end-users.

Governance

The Company has defined the following targets for management: zero tolerance of corruption, adherence to ethical behaviour, zero cases of corruption, bribery, violation of the principles of independence and anti-competitive behaviour.

Practices, policies and future initiatives for transitioning to a more sustainable economy - summary

	Do you have sustainability practices / policies / future initiatives that address the following sustainability issues?	Are they publicly available?	Do the policies have set targets?
Climate change	Yes	Yes	Yes
Circular economy	Yes	No	Yes
Our workforce	Yes	Yes	Yes
Users	Yes	Yes	Yes
Business conduct	Yes	Yes	Yes

A detailed description of practices, policies and future initiatives is given in the next chapter.

[B2]

1.4 Description of practices, policies and future initiatives for transitioning towards a more sustainable economy

Description of practices, policies and future initiatives for transitioning to a more sustainable economy.

	Description of practices, policies and future initiatives	Description of targets
Climate change	The company takes a comprehensive approach to environmental protection in accordance with the concept of sustainable development, supported in selected companies by the ISO 14 001 environmental management system. It applies an environmental policy, which includes a Net Zero climate commitment, measures to reduce energy consumption, emissions from business trips, transition to renewable energy sources and education of employees on savings and environmental protection. Climate targets are globally endorsed by the SBTi initiative and are regularly monitored. Key Policies: Environmental Policy, Travel Policy, Internal Directive on Waste Reduction and Separation, ISO 14001	Achieve Net Zero: By 2030, reduce Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 50% compared to 2019, use 100% renewable electricity, reduce emissions from business trips by 50%, incentivize suppliers to set science-based targets. Reduce office paper consumption and reduce production of unseparated waste.

[C2]

	Description of practices, policies and future initiatives	Description of targets
Circular economy	The company applies circular economy principles – it reduces paper consumption, supports digital transformation, separates waste (paper, plastic, glass, biowaste, electrical waste), reuses used electrical engineering and cooperates with external partners on waste collection and processing. It applies circularity criteria to procurement. These measures are aimed at minimizing our environmental impact and raising employee awareness. Key policies: Environmental policy, internal waste directives, purchasing rules with an emphasis on recyclability and energy efficiency	Minimize waste production, increase share of recycling, reduce paper consumption, increase employee awareness on environmental topics
Our Workforce	The company emphasizes fairness, diversity, inclusion, work-life balance, health and safety of employees. It applies the People Value Proposition Framework, provides development programs, training, well-being activities, supports a hybrid work model and work-life balance. Employees have the opportunity to participate in volunteer activities and benefits. Key policies: We Care, Code of Conduct, People Value Proposition Framework, Data Protection policy, Safe Work Environment policy	Increase satisfaction of employees, promote diversity and inclusion, reduce turnover, ensure zero accidents at work, develop talent and skills of employees. Short-term target values for Our Workforce: • Total training = 56,000 hours • Total number of employees as of 31. December 2025 = 956 • Number of newly-hired employees = 216 • Employee satisfaction rate = min. 75%
Consumers and end-users	The company provides clients with audit, tax, legal, ESG and sustainability services. It helps clients calculate their carbon footprint, implement ESG strategies, transition to a circular economy and improve service quality. It is committed to protecting client data, transparency and ethical behaviour in relation to clients. Key policies: Code of Conduct, internal processes for approval of contracts, Data Protection policy, AML policy	Increase the quality of services, data protection, build trust
Business conduct	The company has a global Code of Conduct in place, ethical standards, whistle blowing mechanism zero tolerance for corruption, discrimination and anti-competitive behaviour. Suppliers are required to comply with the Code of Ethics for Third Parties. The company regularly trains employees on ethics, compliance and anti-Key policies: Code of Conduct, Global Third-Party Code of Conduct, Ethics Line, Anti-corruption policy, Anti-discrimination policy	Zero tolerance for corruption, adherence to ethical behaviour, no cases of corruption, bribery, breach of the principles of independence anti-competitive behaviour.

[C2]

Environmental values

PwC Slovakia is not a manufacturing company, but it still strives to reduce the impact of its activities on the environment, focusing on energy, climate change and the circular economy.

Three of our companies, PricewaterhouseCoopers Slovensko, s.r.o., PricewaterhouseCoopers Advisory s.r.o. and PricewaterhouseCoopers Tax, k.s. are holders of ISO 14001 Environmental Management System certification.

We also raise employee awareness of how they can contribute to reducing energy consumption in the workplace and at home. On World Environment Day, we send an overview of our activities and other steps our employees can take to help the environment.

2.1 Energy and greenhouse gas emissions

We rent office space in Bratislava in the Twin City A building, which in 2017 received an “Excellent” rating in the Certification for Sustainable Buildings (BREEAM certificate), which is part of the voluntary certification system for sustainable construction and is used to assess the environmental performance of buildings. Since 2021, we have used renewable energy sources at our branch in Košice and from 2023 in Bratislava.

As part of energy savings, we have adopted several measures to reduce energy consumption in our office spaces:

1. We keep the heating of office spaces at a maximum of 24 °C on working days.
2. We limit the cooling of indoor spaces by air conditioning to 20 °C.
3. Air conditioning is turned off after the end of working hours from 6:00 p.m. to 6:00 a.m.
4. In open spaces, we have an automatic lighting switch-off system.
5. On weekends and holidays, we turn off coffee makers, kettles, water dispensers and TVs in meeting and conference rooms.

Total energy consumption in 2024 (in MWh)

2024	Renewable Energy Consumption	Non-renewable Energy Consumption	Total Energy Consumption
Electricity	227.57	0	227.57
Fuels	0	0	0
Total	227.57	0	227.57

Total energy consumption in 2023 (in MWh)

2023	Renewable Energy Consumption	Non-renewable Energy Consumption	Total Energy Consumption
Electricity	242.47	0	242.47
Fuels	0	0	0
Total	242.47	0	242.47

In 2024, we reduced our energy consumption from 242.5 MWh to 227.6 MWh compared to 2023, a decrease of more than 6%.

2.1.1 Greenhouse gas emissions

We calculated greenhouse gas emissions according to the GHG Protocol, using the operational control consolidation approach, i.e. aggregated data from our five PwC Slovakia companies. The calculation of indirect emissions for Scope 2 was carried out:

- using location-based emission factors (location-based method[1])
- using market-based emission factors (market-based method[2])

The calculation of emissions for Scope 1 and Scope 3 for 2020-2022 was carried out using emission factors published by the Department for Energy Security & Net Zero of the UK (DESNZ).[3]

[1] EIB Project Carbon Footprint Methodologies: Methodologies for the Assessment of Project GHG Emissions and Emission Variations (2020). Luxembourg: European Investment Bank. ISBN 978-92-861-4715-9.

EIB Project Carbon Footprint Methodologies: Methodologies for the Assessment of Project GHG Emissions and Emission Variations (2022). Luxembourg: European Investment Bank [online] [accessed 2024-05-09].

Available at: https://www.eib.org/attachments/lucalli/eib_project_carbon_footprint_methodologies_2023_en.pdf
For data consistency, a single source of emission factors is used. The emission factor for the Slovak Republic for the year 2020 was also applied to the year 2021 due to the absence of EIB emission factor data for that year. For the calendar years 2022 to 2024, emission factors from the 2022 source were used.

[2] Association of Issuing Bodies: European Residual Mixes [online] [accessed 2024-05-09]. Available at: https://www.aib-net.org/facts/european-residual-mix

[3] UK Government: Government conversion factors for company reporting of greenhouse gas emissions [online].

Available at: https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/government-conversion-factors-for-company-reporting

Direct emissions in Scope 1 were zero for 2024, as we did not have any company vehicles. For work purposes, employees use public transport, contracted taxi services, their own cars, or rent a vehicle from a contracted company.

Scope 2 consists of indirect emissions from purchased consumed energy. These emissions include electricity to operate offices, heating and air conditioning. We have switched to renewable energy in our office space, which has zero emissions according to the GHG Protocol. When calculating emissions from the consumption of purchased energy, according to the GHG Protocol a zero-emission factor is calculated on the basis of a market-based method, for the location-based method, the emission factor is determined on the basis of the energy mix of the Slovak Republic.

Emissions in 2024 compared to 2023

Greenhouse gas emissions (t CO_2 eq.)	2024		2023	
	Absolute values	GHG intensity per net income	Absolute values	GHG intensity per net income
Direct emissions (Scope 1)	0.00	0.00000000	0.00	0.00000000
Indirect emissions from purchased energy (Scope 2 market-based)	0.00	0.00000000	0.00	0.00000000
Indirect emissions from purchased energy (Scope 2 location-based)	37.32	0.00000041	39.77	0.00000045
Other indirect emissions (Scope 3)	313.00*	0.00000345	271.79	0.00000308
1. Purchased goods and services	7.33		9.12	
5. Waste generated in operations	3.74		4.55	
6. Business trips	301.92		259.12	
Total emissions (market-based)	313.00	0.00000345	271.79	0.00000308
Total emissions (location-based)	350.32	0.00000386	311.56	0.00000353

*Other indirect emissions have been rounded up due to rounding of the different Scope 3 categories.

86%

of our emissions are emissions from business trips. (location-based).

Scope 3 covers other indirect emissions that occur within our value chain, i.e. activities that are not part of our ownership or control. They include emissions from purchasing materials and services, waste disposal and from vehicles used for business travel and other emissions generated during business travel. Scope 3 accounts for the largest portion of our emissions and is therefore the most significant part of our carbon footprint calculation.

Emissions from business travel include emissions from all types of transportation used for work purposes by our employees, such as air travel, employee personal vehicles, contracted taxi and car rental services, train and bus transport, and overnight stays in domestic and foreign hotels during business trips or corporate events.

Our calculation of our carbon footprint includes purchased electrical and electronic devices we use in our daily work. These devices include laptops, monitors, smartphones, speakers, tablets, microwaves (small devices). refrigerators and dishwashers (large devices) in our employee kitchens. For each device, we calculate the emissions by multiplying their weight by the appropriate emission factor. This calculation gives us information about the emissions from the use of electrical and electronic devices.

Information about our future initiatives and targets related to reducing our carbon footprint is contained in chapter 2.1.2 GHG reduction targets and climate transition.

[B3]

2.1.2. GHG reduction targets and climate transition

Commitment to **Net Zero**

2021

In 2021, we signed up to the Net Zero commitment globally and gained the approval of the SBTi short-term targets by the initiative.

2030

Our global short-term targets up to 2030:

50%

By the end of the FY30, reduce absolute Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 50% compared to the FY19.

50%

Reduce absolute emissions by the end of the FY30 emissions by 50% compared to the FY19.

100%

Switch to 100% renewable electricity at all locations by the end of FY30.

50%

Target of 50% of our suppliers of purchased goods and services (by emissions) set science-based targets to reduce their impact on the climate.

Climate targets of PwC Slovakia

	Merná jednotka	Východiskový rok 2019	Cieľová hodnota 2025	Podiel 2025	Cieľová hodnota 2030	Podiel 2030
Direct emissions (Scope 1)	tCO_2e	0.65	n/a	n/a	0.32	-50%
Indirect emissions from purchased energy (Scope 2 market-based)	tCO_2e	53.83	n/a	n/a	26.91	-50%
Indirect emissions from purchased energy (Scope 2 location-based)	tCO_2e	54.48	n/a	n/a	27.24	-50%
Other indirect emissions (Scope 3)	tCO_2e	500.11	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
Other indirect emissions (Scope 3) 6. Business travels	tCO_2e	484.05	n/a	n/a	242.02	-50%

The largest share of our carbon footprint is from business travel. To meet our commitment to Net Zero, we must reduce total emissions from business travel by 50% by 2030 compared to the base year of 2019, By the end of the calendar year 2024, we had reduced these emissions by over 37%. We also reduced the number of kilometres travelled by all modes of transport by over 47% by the end of calendar year 2024 compared to the base year 2019.

We support the reduction of our carbon footprint by motivating our employees to commute to work by bike, and they can use the showers in our offices. We also have measures in place to reduce energy consumption and the company's overall carbon footprint.

Our in-house ESG team provides education for employees on climate change and supports activities to reduce greenhouse gas emissions.

Our environment and climate change values are also applied to our clients. We provide a range of ESG and sustainability services, such as climate risk analysis and carbon footprint calculation.

PwC Slovakia does not operate in sectors with a high climate impact and does not have a climate change transition plan.

[C3]

[C4 - The Company has not identified any climate risks or transition events.]

2.2 Resource use, circular economy and waste management

PwC Slovakia applies circular economy principles and we strive to reduce the amount of waste and increase circularity. We separate waste into municipal, glass, plastic and paper and since 2023 we also separate biowaste at our Bratislava offices. We also collect used batteries separately for disposal at our Košice office. We use glass jars or ceramic cups instead of disposable paper cups, which reduces disposable waste. As a non-manufacturing company, we do not produce waste as a by-product of our processes. Waste management is handled by an external company that collects and processes waste outside of our office premises. Information on waste only includes waste from the Bratislava office and is based on the best estimate of the building manager according to the size of the leased premises. Data from our Košice office is not available.

Total waste production for the calendar year 2024 and comparison with 2023

Type of waste	Waste produced (t)		Total waste generated in 2024, of which:	
	2024	2023	Waste intended for recycling or reuse	Waste to be disposed of
Non-hazardous waste	**15.78**	**12.61**	**53.11%**	**46.89%**
Paper and cardboard packaging	1.61	1.79	100%	0%
Plastic packaging	0.33	0.27	100%	0%
Mixed municipal waste	7.40	9.02	0%	100%
Glass containers	0.11	0.11	100%	0%
Organic kitchen waste	6.24	0.96	100%	0%
E-waste	0.09	0.46	100%	0%
Hazardous waste	**0**	**0**	**-**	**-**

In 2024, total waste production increased from 12.61 tonnes to 15.78 tonnes compared to the previous year, the amount of mixed municipal waste decreased by 18%, and sorted waste increased from 28.5% to over 53% of total waste, mainly thanks to an increase in the separation of organic kitchen waste compared to the previous year from 0.96 tonnes to 6.24 tonnes.

Office paper is the main component of consumables. We strive to reduce its use to conserve natural resources, reduce the environmental impacts associated with the use of materials and minimize waste. We are constantly looking for new ways to support digital and virtual work with the least energy consumption possible in all areas of our business, including relationships with our clients. We develop and implement new workflows, software and cloud solutions that contribute to reducing paper consumption in our offices.

We monitor the amount of printing paper consumption by every user. Printers have a preset double-sided black and black and white printing mode and we use recycled paper. We also have a special container for used office paper and we respect data protection security when recycling.

We participate in sustainable forestry projects. As part of the Zelené Slovensko project, we helped local foresters in March 2024 in the Mestské lesy of Bratislava. 16 employees worked for 96 hours in this activity as part of volunteering.

The Company does not operate in a sector that uses significant material flows.

[B7]

[B4 –Air, water and soil pollution: The Company is not obliged by law to report emissions of pollutants into air, water and soil via the environmental management system, and given our minimal impact in this area, we do not report this information.]

[B5 – Biodiversity: The Company does not own, lease or manage any sites in the vicinity of biodiversity-sensitive areas, and therefore does not report such information.]

[B6 – Water: The Company does not have production processes that consume significant water, and so it does not report such information.]

03

Social values

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employees took advantage of the opportunity to work temporarily from abroad in the calendar year 2024.

3.1 Our workforce

Employees are key to us. We create an environment that supports their professional and personal growth. We promote fairness, diversity and work-life balance. We also provide consulting and mentoring to help our employees achieve their personal and professional goals.

Today, employees place increasing emphasis on work-life balance. PwC's We Care policy helps to overcome the stereotype of the difficulty of working for the "Big Four" and supports the development of employees' individual potential. Our corporate culture has become a tool that helps us retain talent.

The principles of our approach to employees is based on the values of the People Value Proposition Framework (PVP Framework):

1 Innovative, purpose-led work

2 Appreciating and caring for our people

3 Inclusive leadership and teamwork

4 Future-focused growth and development

5 Evolving, leading-edge flexibility

The PVP Framework is constantly evolving to reflect the diverse needs of employees and support the solver community. We also seek to ensure the well-being of our employees with employee benefits. These include health benefits, discounts, cafeteria and annual credit for leisure activities. Travelling using the Global Mobility program is not only a benefit for our employees, but also a means of supporting their career development. This program is for employees with excellent work results, and who have achieved seniority within PwC.

We regularly monitor the effectiveness of all our initiatives via internal satisfaction surveys. The Staff Advisory Board provides a platform for all employees to have their say on workplace issues, allowing them to bring new ideas and drive change. Board representatives are directly elected by employees into two chambers, Junior (juniors and senior consultants) and Senior (managers). Representatives meet monthly.

3.1.1 General information on employees

We regularly collect, update and store employee data in our internal software tool. All data stated below is based on the Headcount method, i.e. the total number of employees as at 31 December 2024, including contract students and part-time employees. PwC Slovakia does not have a temporary employee category.

There was a decrease in the number of total employees in 2024 to 950 as of 31 December 2024 at PwC Slovakia,.

Number of employees by type of working time

	Number of employees 2024	Number of employees 2023
Employees with a non-guaranteed number of hours	60	80
Part-time employees	70	75
Full-time employees	820	842
Total	950	997

Number of employees by gender

	Number of employees 2024	Number of employees 2023
Male	388	426
Female	562	571
Total	950	997

PwC Slovakia operates and only has employees in Slovakia.

In calendar year 2024, the Company recorded an employee turnover rate of 24.2%.

[B8]

3.2 Health and safety

Ensuring the health and safety of our employees is one of our main social responsibility pillars. We regularly evaluate risks to the health, safety and well-being of our employees and we consider the risk of burnout to be the most significant risk. In this context, we monitor the number of overtime hours broken down by gender and each employee category. We have reduced the amount of overtime in recent years.

We mitigate the risk of burnout via employee well-being initiatives. The Be Well, Work Well initiative helps to modify employee behaviour and habits to support the four energy dimensions (physical, mental, emotional and spiritual). The Activate Yourself program motivates employees to engage in leisure activities to recharge energy using small rewards. In the calendar year 2024, there were 200 participants in this program.

Employees and their family members can also take part in the Work-Life Coaching Program, a tailor-made advisory and consulting program. In cooperation with Human Dynamic Europe, employees receive free confidential counselling on personal psychological counselling. For the calendar year 2024, 287 employees participated in the program, which led to 945 consultations. From the calendar year 2024, we offer individual advice at our workplaces to all employees at the managerial level and above. In 2024, 38 employees participated in the program, and there were 78 consultations.

From the calendar year 2023, PwC Slovakia allows each employee to devote 2 working days per financial year to manual volunteering in a non-profit organization of their choice. The list of activities and NGOs is updated throughout the year.

No work-related accident was recorded in the calendar year 2024 among employees and the rate of work-related accidents was 0%. There were no fatalities as a result of work-related injuries and work-related ill health among employees.

[B9]

3.3 Remuneration, collective bargaining and training

PwC Slovakia employees receive a wage that is higher than EUR 982, i.e. the applicable minimum wage in the Slovak Republic, which is determined by Act No. 663/2007 Coll. on the Minimum Wage. The amount indicated refers to the full-time equivalent.

3.3.1. Equal pay

Pay ratio* of female to male employees in each employment category

	2024	2023
Intern / Trainee (f/m)	-9.1%	1.8%
Associate (f/m)	4.3%	3.2%
Senior Associate (f/m)	10%	7.1%
Manager (f/m)	3.8%	1.6%
Senior Manager (f/m)	-1.7%	-5.9%
Director (f/m)	-11.1%	-3.6%
Partner (f/m)	2.2%	-16.6%

* Remuneration includes basic salary, supplementary and variable wage components.

3.3.2 Collective bargaining

No collective agreements are in force at PwC entities in Slovakia.

3.3.3 Training and education

We support the continuous development of employees via programs that reflect current market needs, technological changes and AI development. In this way, we increase the professional skills of our people and the quality of services for clients. In the calendar year 2024, PwC Slovakia employees completed 54,091 hours of training, an average of almost 57 hours per employee, a 10% increase compared to 2023. This significant increase is due to the streamlining of the methodology used compared to the previous year and by making the calculation of hours trained more precise, and by new requirements for the expertise of auditors in relation to sustainability assurance, or the expansion of services provided for automation, digitalization and the use of AI. In October 2024, selected employees participated in training on the reporting of sustainability statements under the EU's Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD).

Average number of hours spent on training

	2024	2023
Total	57	49
Male	63	55
Female	52	45

As regards the average number of training hours per employee by gender, there was a technical deficiency in the internal system, which does not provide data on the training of employees who have terminated their employment during the year, which caused a difference in the average number of hours per reported number of employees at the end of the year. Year-on-year, we recorded an overall increase in the average number of training hours by 10%.

Taktiež poskytujeme priestor na rozvoj širokej škály mäkkých zručností, tzv. business skills, ako sú komunikačné a prezentačné schopnosti, spätná väzba, tímová spolupráca, v prípade manažérov doplnené o leadership či zvládanie náročných situácií. Zamestnancom ponúkame tiež jazykové kurzy – angličtinu, nemčinu a individuálne kurzy slovenčiny pre cudzincov.

Newly-hired employees receive introductory training sessions that provide them with a basic understanding of our internal tools.

[B10]

3.4 Additional (general) workforce characteristics

Our top management are our partners and executives according to the Commercial Register of the Slovak Republic, who hold the highest positions and responsibility in society. In the calendar year 2024, the female-to-male ratio was 1:3.6, so for every female employee in top management there are 3.6 male employees. In the previous year this ratio was 1:3.8.

[C5]

3.5 Human rights policies and processes

PwC Slovakia adheres to professional standards, principles of integrity, independence and a global Code of Conduct that is binding on all stakeholders. It is part of all contracts with employees, clients and suppliers and provides guidance in various situations. Employees must follow the applicable professional standards, including those set out in the International Ethics Standards Board for Accountants (IESBA).

We respect and support internationally recognized human rights. We work to protect against human rights violations. We comply with applicable labour and employer laws and do not tolerate harassment, discrimination, retaliation, intimidation, bullying or disrespectful behaviour during the conduct of our activities.

All employees are required to complete an Annual Compliance Confirmation (ACC), confirming compliance with PwC's ethics, independence and conflict of interest rules.

Our company has a complaint resolution mechanism in place for potential human rights violations (see next chapter).

3.5.1 Reporting violations of ethical standards

PwC Slovakia employees have a number of channels available to report violations of ethical standards and serious concerns and threats. They can report ethical concerns or violations in a number of ways – directly to the ethics team, to the regional team via the Ethics Helpline, or anonymously via a virtual mailbox. All complaints are handled confidentially, transparently and fairly, and employees are protected from retaliation for filing in good faith. The Ethics Helpline is available 24/7 and receives suggestions from employees, clients and third parties. It is available for the reporting of serious violations of rules, laws or the Code of Conduct, and for finding answers to questions about ethical rules. The Ethics Committee is composed of company representatives and deals with complaints and keeps records of them in the case management system.

Complaints are confirmed within seven days and an investigation is completed within three months (within six in justified cases). The whistleblower is kept informed throughout the process about the progress of the investigation in accordance with the protection of personal data. No-one who files a complaint in good faith may be penalized for doing so.

PwC regularly raises awareness of ethical standards, for example, via Ethics Awareness Week, where employees are informed about whistleblowing channels and the Code of Conduct.

Employees can make use of the Ethical Decision-Making Framework, which complements the PwC Code of Conduct

[C6]

3.5.2 Serious negative human rights incidents

There were no confirmed incidents as regards human rights violations by PwC Slovakia employees, and the Company is not aware of any confirmed incidents related to workers in the value chain, affected communities or clients. A confirmed incident is any legal action or complaint reported via our ethics channels for reporting incidents or third-party complaint mechanisms. During the calendar year 2024, PwC Slovakia did not identify any substantiated complaints regarding violations of client privacy and loss of client data under the GDPR. We did not receive any substantiated complaints from our clients regarding data protection.

[C7]

Management values

4.1 Convictions and fines for corruption and bribery

There were no confirmed cases of corruption in 2024 and the number of final convictions and total amount of fines imposed for violations of anti-corruption and anti-bribery laws was zero.

All employees were trained and instructed on the rules and procedures as regards the fight against corruption.

[B11]

4.2 Revenues from certain sectors and exclusion from EU reference benchmarks

The company does not conduct any business activities which involve selling weapons, tobacco products, fossil fuels or the production of chemicals, and does not generate revenue in these sectors.

The Company is not excluded from any EU benchmarks that are aligned with the Paris Agreement.

[C8]

4.3. Gender diversity ratio on the governance body

PwC Slovakia has a supervisory board for PricewaterhouseCoopers Advisory s.r.o. and for PricewaterhouseCoopers Slovensko, s.r.o., which consists of our partners. who hold the highest positions and responsibility in our company.
In the calendar year 2024, the gender diversity ratio was 1:2.75, i.e. 2.75 male employees for every female employee on the supervisory board. In the previous year this ratio was 1:3.25.

[C9]

About this report

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This sustainability report is not subject to external verification by an auditor. However, PwC Slovakia uses external audit services for the verification of financial statements and annual reports as required and subject to legislative requirements. The auditor is appointed by the general meeting of the company's shareholders.

PwC Slovakia publishes its sustainability report annually, and this sustainability report is published for the first time in accordance with VSME standards, which is available on the link below:

https://www.pwc.com/sk/en/corporate-sustainability.html

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Data reporting

All quantitative data in this report has been obtained by extraction or direct calculation using our internal systems and tools, unless marked as estimates, extrapolations, etc. Our reporting process is based on data obtained from department-specific measurements that have been provided to our ESG team. The carbon footprint is measured in accordance with international Greenhouse Gas Protocol methods. Quantitative indicators give information on the impacts generated by the organizations in direct relation to our activities. In addition, we also provide information about our managerial approach to impacts that are related to our activities and business relationships outside the organization.

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